

COOK WITH BREE · PRINTABLE MEAL PLAN

Special Dinner

A printable celebration menu from Cook with Bree

Feeds 2–6 · \$9

Welcome

When dinner should feel like an occasion — birthdays, guests, or a slow Sunday — this menu gives you a clear shopping list and timeline so you can enjoy the evening too.

Print this plan, stick it on the fridge, and shop once. Recipes live on the Cook with Bree website — use the links at the end when you need full instructions.

Menu

Starter

Honey Roasted Root Vegetables (small plates)

Roast while main rests

Main

Roasted Beef Luwombo

Start 2.5–3 hours before serving

Side

Matooke with Groundnut Sauce or Coconut Rice

Steam / cook alongside main

Bread

Warm Chapati or Sandwich Bread

Finish 20 minutes before serving

Sweet

Grandma's Banana Bread with butter

Bake earlier in the day

Cooking Timeline

T-3 hours

Marinate beef; prep banana leaves/parcels for luwombo; preheat oven if roasting finish.

T-2.5 hours

Start cooking luwombo low and covered.

T-2 hours

Bake banana bread (or earlier). Set the table.

T-1 hour

Start matooke steamer or coconut rice. Prep groundnut sauce if using.

T-45 min

Toss root vegetables with honey and oil; roast.

T-30 min

Make chapati or warm sandwich bread. Finish sauce.

T-10 min

Plate starter vegetables; rest the meat; fluff rice/matooke.

Serve

Bring everything to the table warm. Light a candle. Enjoy.

Grocery List

Produce

- Onions, garlic, ginger, tomatoes
- Sweet potatoes, carrots, parsnips or mixed roots
- Fresh rosemary or parsley
- Ripe bananas for banana bread
- Green bananas/plantains if making matooke

Pantry

- Coconut milk or peanut butter for sauce
- Rice or flour for chapati/bread
- Honey, spices (coriander, cumin, paprika, cinnamon)
- Tomato paste, stock, oil/butter, sugar, flour, baking soda

Protein

- Beef stew meat (about 2 lb)
- Eggs
- Butter/yogurt for baking

Other

- Banana leaves or parchment + kitchen twine
- Candles / nice serving dishes (optional)

Prep Tips

- Bake banana bread the morning of — one less thing at dinner hour.
- Chop all aromatics before guests arrive.
- Don't open the luwombo pot too often — trust the timeline.

Recipe Links on Cook with Bree

- Roasted Beef Luwombo — </recipes/roasted-beef-luwombo>
- Matooke with Groundnut Sauce — </recipes/matooke-with-groundnut-sauce>
- Coconut Rice — </recipes/coconut-rice>
- Honey Roasted Vegetables — </recipes/honey-roasted-vegetables>
- Chapati — </recipes/chapati>
- Grandma's Banana Bread — </recipes/grandmas-banana-bread>

Thank you

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With love,

Bree